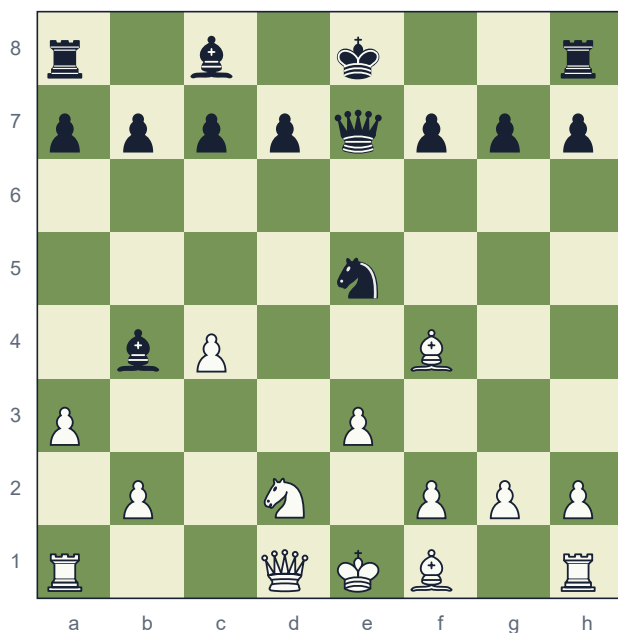


Budapest, Fajarowicz and Blumenfeld

Early ...e5 or ...b5 after 1...Nf6

YOUR REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Accept the Budapest pawn with development in mind. Against the Blumenfeld, prefer Bg5 and a healthy center to defending a dangerous extra flank pawn.



Main-line anchor - Black to move

THE PAWN STRUCTURE

The Budapest uses piece activity to recover e5; the Blumenfeld offers a flank pawn to build a large central mass. These require different practical responses.

WHAT BLACK WANTS

Budapest: ...Ng4, ...Nc6 and ...Bb4+. Fajarowicz: ...Ne4 and tactical queen/bishop activity. Blumenfeld: ...exd5 and central expansion if White spends time taking b5.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Meet checks with useful development.
2. Do not defend e5 with too many pawn moves if Black can recover it safely anyway.
3. A pin on f6 can be more valuable than an extra b-pawn.

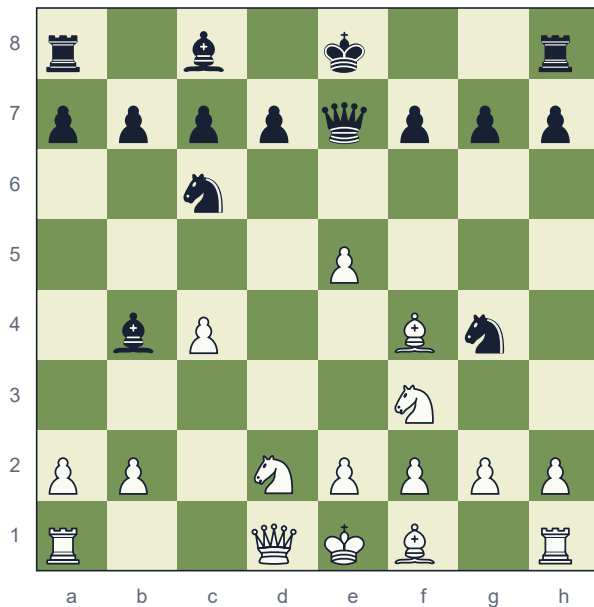
Line pages contain a selected opening anchor plus an illustrative checked continuation. They are not a forced script. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Budapest: the Bf4 and Nbd2 system

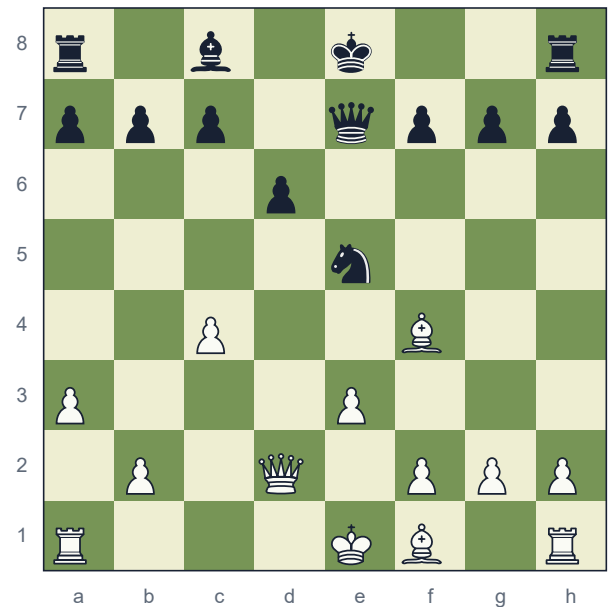
STUDY LINE 18-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e5 3. dxe5 Ng4 4. Nf3 Nc6 5. Bf4 Bb4+ 6. Nbd2 Qe7 7. a3 Ngxe5 8. Nxe5 Nxe5 9. e3 Bxd2+ 10. Qxd2 d6

Selected anchor ends with 9. e3. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Nbd2 answers the check and supports development. After the central exchanges, e3 opens the f1 bishop without weakening the king.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop Be2 or Bd3 and castle. The bishop pair or central space may offer lasting chances once the tactical phase ends.

WATCH FOR

Do not take on e5 with the wrong piece before checking pins and ...Nd3+ ideas.

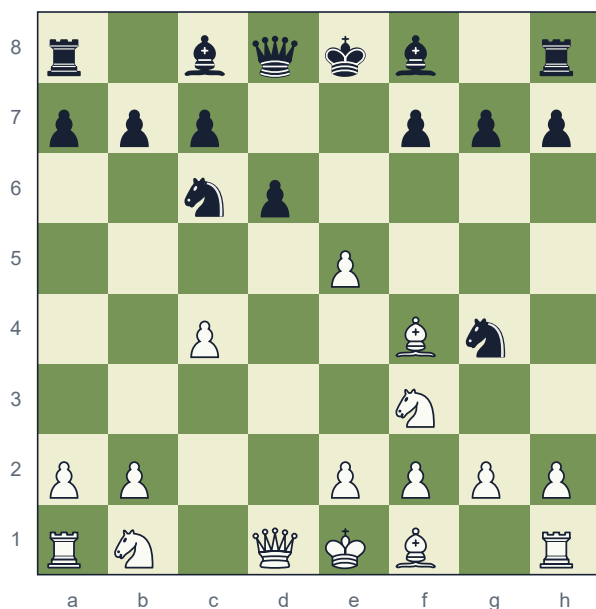
REMEMBER Develop against the gambit; do not worship the extra pawn.

02 Budapest without the bishop check

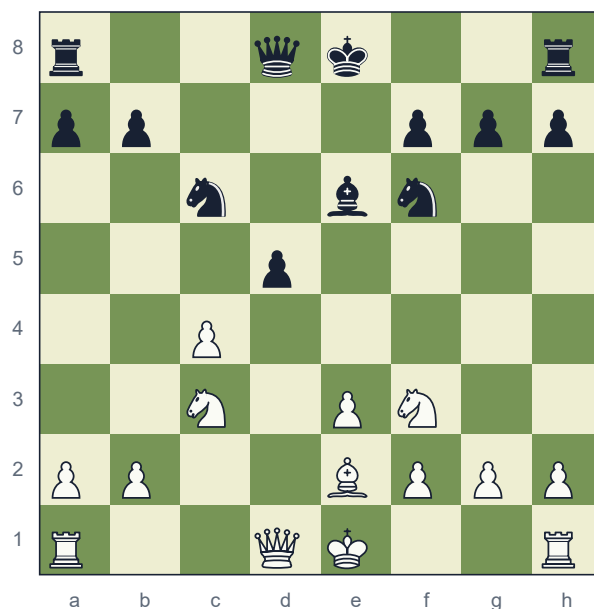
STUDY LINE 18-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e5 3. dxe5 Ng4 4. Nf3 Nc6 5. Bf4 d6 6. exd6 Bxd6 7. Bxd6 cxd6 8. e3 Be6 9. Nc3 Nf6 10. Be2 d5

Selected anchor ends with 6... Bxd6. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 5 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Black returns to straightforward development. The e5 pawn disappears, but White can maintain a healthy position.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

e3, Be2 and castling are priorities. Keep central squares controlled and challenge active black pieces.

WATCH FOR

Do not use a sequence from the ...Bb4+ line when the bishop is on d6; the pins differ.

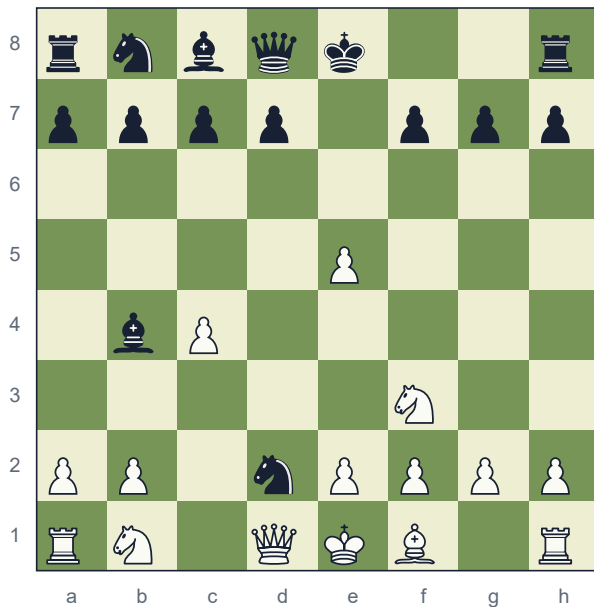
REMEMBER A returned pawn can finish the opening problem.

03 Fajarowicz: the immediate ...Ne4

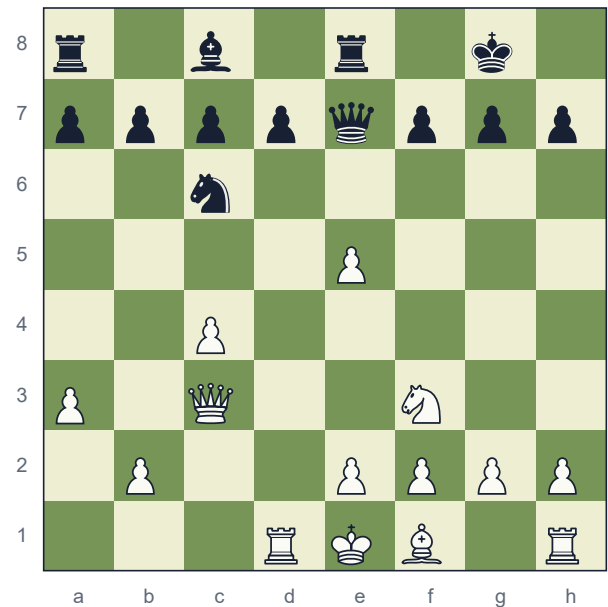
STUDY LINE 18-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e5 3. dxe5 Ne4 4. Nf3 Bb4+ 5. Bd2 Nxd2 6. Nbx d2 Qe7 7. a3 Bxd2+ 8. Qxd2 Nc6 9. Qc3 O-O 10. Rd1 Re8

Selected anchor ends with 6. Nbx d2. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 5 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Develop while answering the check. The knight recapture on d2 helps cover central squares and avoids needless queen exposure.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Bring out the f1 bishop, castle, and keep the e5 pawn only when it is convenient. Black's knight adventure has cost time.

WATCH FOR

Queen checks on h4 or a5 can combine with a loose piece. Always inspect checks before grabbing a second pawn.

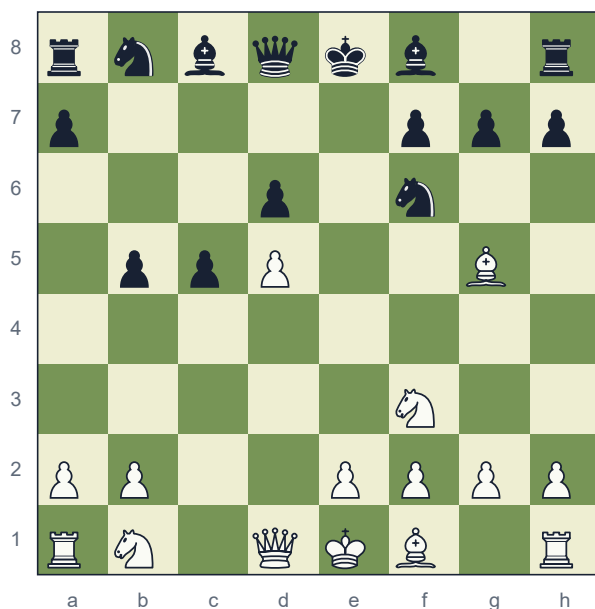
REMEMBER Trade away the active knight and develop.

04 Blumenfeld declined with Bg5

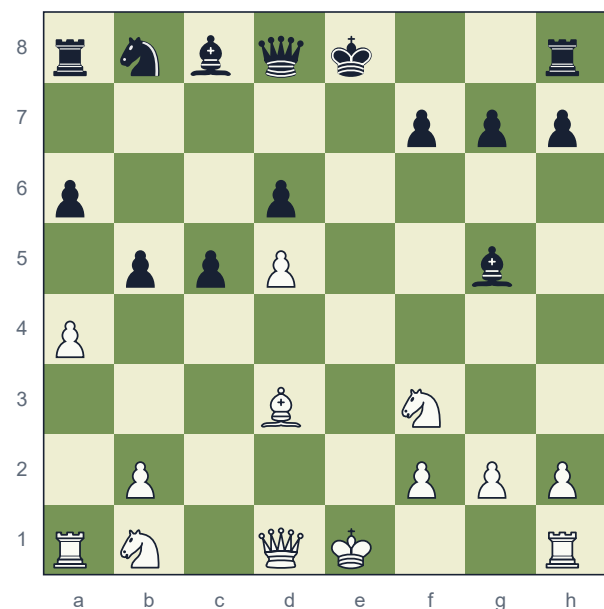
STUDY LINE 18-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 c5 4. d5 b5 5. Bg5 exd5 6. cxd5 d6 7. e4 a6 8. a4 Be7 9. Bd3 Nxd5 10. exd5 Bxg5

Selected anchor ends with 7. e4. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Bg5 pins the f6 knight and declines to help Black build the ideal accepted-gambit center. e4 supports a useful space advantage.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop the b1 knight, choose a safe bishop square, and castle. Be alert to ...Be7 breaking the pin before Black strikes centrally.

WATCH FOR

The f6 knight may become unpinned after ...Be7. Recalculate captures that relied on the pin.

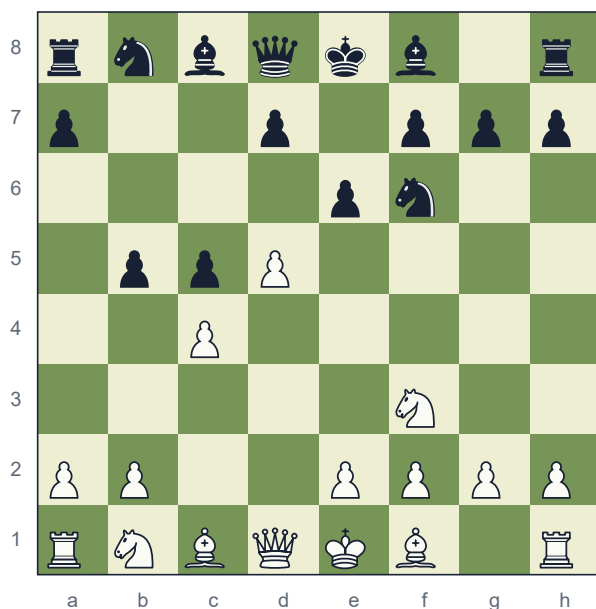
REMEMBER Prefer central control to a risky flank pawn.

05 Blumenfeld: Black develops ...Be7

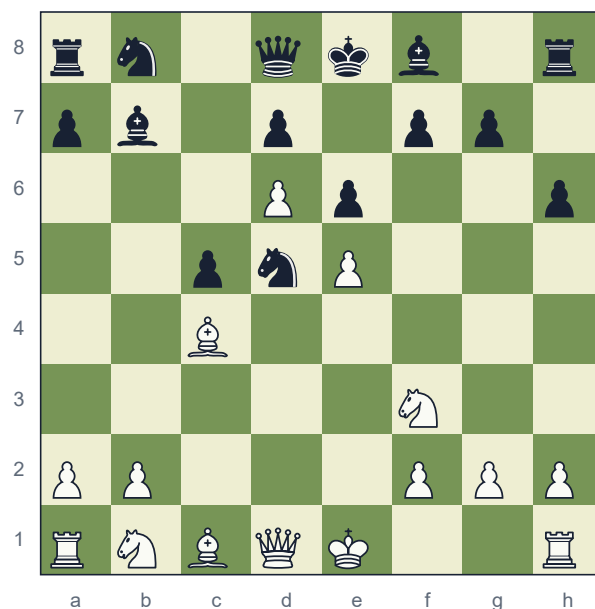
STUDY LINE 18-05

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 c5 4. d5 b5 5. Bg5 Be7 6. d6 Bf8 7. e4 bxc4 8. e5 h6 9. Bc1 Nd5 10. Bxc4 Bb7

Selected anchor ends with 5... Be7. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 4 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Black addresses the pin without fixing the central pawn structure. White must now choose how to complete development and handle the tension.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

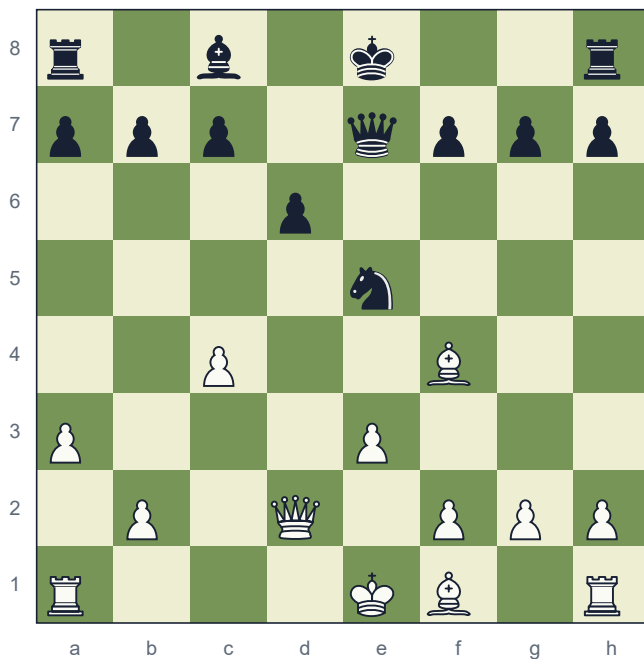
e3 or a central exchange may be appropriate. Check ...exd5 and ...bxc4 before making a quiet move.

WATCH FOR

Do not pretend the pin still prevents ...Nxd5 after the bishop has moved to e7.

REMEMBER Recount defenders whenever a pin is broken.

Review before your next game



Main-line study position - White to move

1. IDENTIFY THE STRUCTURE.

The Budapest uses piece activity to recover e5; the Blumenfeld offers a flank pawn to build a large central mass. These require different practical responses.

2. NAME BLACK'S PLAN.

Budapest: ...Ng4, ...Nc6 and ...Bb4+. Fajarowicz: ...Ne4 and tactical queen/bishop activity. Blumenfeld: ...exd5 and central expansion if White spends time taking b5.

3. CHOOSE YOUR NEXT JOB.

Develop Be2 or Bd3 and castle. The bishop pair or central space may offer lasting chances once the tactical phase ends.

RECONSTRUCTION DRILL

Set up the starting position and play the main study line without looking. After each Black move, say what changed. If you cannot explain your reply, stop at that position and review the relevant line page.

DECISION DRILL

Return to the diagram. Write two candidate moves and a likely reply to each. You are not trying to guess the next engine move: you are testing whether your choices fit the structure and survive checks, captures and threats.

SELF-CHECK

Can you identify every capture and recapture in the line? Can you state one move-order exception? Can you explain the final position without using the opening name?

Related practice: Booklet 24. Use the matching line ID in the PGN companion. Opening names: Lichess public opening dataset; original course choices and analysis, checked with Stockfish 18.